

Paper 1: Listening and understanding in Spanish

Content

Students are assessed on their understanding of standard spoken Spanish in a variety of scenarios.

Students will need to:

- identify the overall message, key points, details and opinions
- deduce meaning from a variety of spoken texts
- recognise the relationship between past, present and future events
- recognise and respond to key information, important themes and ideas in spoken text, including authentic sources, adapted and abridged, as appropriate
- be able to answer questions, extract information, evaluate and draw conclusions.

This paper draws on vocabulary and structures across all the themes (outlined on pages 7–8).

Students are presented with recorded scenarios involving one or more speakers in public and social settings. Recordings include authentic sources addressing the themes. Recorded material features both male and female voices and represents different age groups.

Students should be given the opportunity to become accustomed to hearing the Spanish language spoken in a range of styles and registers.

Recordings for individual questions within the assessment vary in length, including both short and longer spoken passages, using both familiar language and, where appropriate, more complex language and abstract material, as appropriate to the tier.

To prepare students adequately for this assessment, teachers should present and exploit a range of vocabulary relevant to each theme listed and build on the Key Stage 3 Programme of Study, where appropriate.

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- The assessment is out of 50 marks.
- Students must be allocated five minutes in which to read through the paper before the first extract of the recording starts. This gives students an opportunity to familiarise themselves with the length and the layout of the paper and to read the questions before hearing the first extract.
- Students will listen to the recording featuring Spanish-language speakers who will speak at a rate appropriate to the expected level of student understanding.
- Each passage is recorded twice, with pauses following the second hearing to allow each student sufficient time to write or note their response to each question (or part of a question) and to read the next question before the related extract is played.
- Recordings will be issued as audio files via our Secure Download Service (SDS) prior to the exam.
- Each question is set in a context drawn from the topics. The assessment tasks will feature general content that is familiar and accessible to all students.
- Students must answer all questions in both sections.
- *Foundation tier*
 - The assessment is 35 minutes, including 5 minutes' reading time.
 - Section A contains 12 questions set in English. Question types will comprise both multiple-response and short-answer open response questions. The instructions to students are in English.
 - Section B contains two questions set in Spanish. Question types comprise of multiple-response questions. The instructions to students are in Spanish.
- *Higher tier*
 - The assessment is 45 minutes, including 5 minutes' reading time.
 - Section A contains two questions set in Spanish. Question types comprise of multiple-response questions. The instructions to students are in Spanish.
 - Section B contains eight questions set in English. Question types comprise of both multiple-response and short-answer open response questions. The instructions to students are in English.
- Four of the questions will be common to both tiers.
- For both tiers, there is no requirement for students to produce written responses in Spanish.
- The use of dictionaries is not permitted.

Sample assessment materials

A sample paper and mark scheme for this paper can be found in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 1/Level 2 GCSE (9–1) in Spanish Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs)* document.